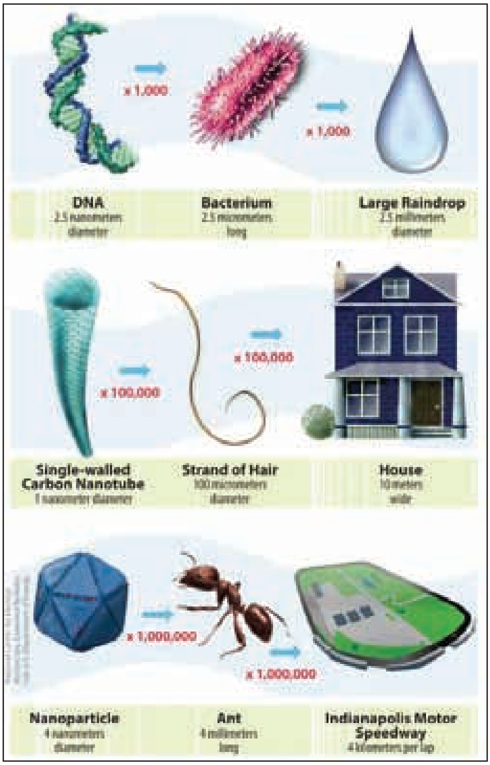
Seeing

As you've probably guessed by now, it's no easy task for scientists to see what's going on in the extremely small world of nanotechnology. You need are high-powered microscopes that use unique methods to allow visibility of surface features on the atomic scale, thus introducing you to the world of modern nanotechnology.

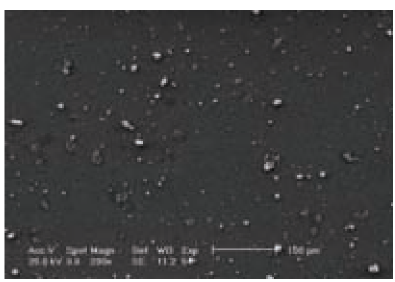
Beginning as early as the 1930s, scientists were using instruments such as the scanning electron microscope, the transmission electron microscope and the field ion microscope for this purpose. The most recent and notable developments in microscopy are the scanning tunneling microscope and the atomic force microscope.



Putting things in perspective

Working

Nanotechnology requires the ability to understand and precisely manipulate and control those materials in a useful way. It demands an understanding of the various types and dimensions of nanoscale materials. Different types of nanomaterials are named for their individual shapes and dimensions - particles, tubes, wires, films, flakes or



Seeing at the nanoscale